

Climate Justice Literacy: Stories-We-Live-By, Ecolinguistics, and Classroom Practice

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Promote climate justice literacy by guiding students to become more aware of ecologically destructive and beneficial stories-we-live-by.

Stories inform and guide literacy educators as they shepherd students through fictional accounts in literature and through real-life narratives. Our purpose in this article is to provide a framework for literacy educators to approach the complex socioscientific topic of climate change through a lens of stories. Based on our own work in many middle school, high school, and university classrooms in literacy and social studies education, we drew from the field of ecolinguistics to make a case that literacy educators have a significant role in leading more systematic study and critical analysis of the stories-we-live-by (Stibbe, 2015), or the larger narratives that guide individual and collective sense-making, especially about the relationship between humans and the environment. Equipped with instructional commitments to inquiry-based learning, we considered ways that an ecolinguistics perspective can help teachers and students identify and examine harmful and beneficial stories-we-live-by about perhaps the most significant topic of our times, climate change. Such an approach points to a set of essential understandings for literacy educators that helps frame the issue of climate change in terms of climate justice beyond polarizing politics to instead focus on the relationships that human beings have with the environment, our common home (Pope Francis, 2015).

Critical Text Analysis: A Starting Point

There is a long history of educators committed to helping students carefully and critically read and evaluate

texts (Shannon, 1990), with a text defined here as the use of different semiotic resources, such as words, images, sounds, and movement, that offer different versions of reality based on how the text is selected and organized (Janks, 2018). Central to this process is examining the relation between language and power (e.g., Comber, 2001; Fairclough, 1992/2013; Luke & Freebody, 1997). This includes work situated in contexts of globalization (Baildon & Damico, 2011; Luke, 2014) and with cosmopolitan perspectives that focus more centrally on issues of global human rights (e.g., Dunkerly-Bean, Bean, & Alnajjar, 2014). Fundamentally, such critical literacy practices involve close textual critique and reflexivity on the part of the reader (Baildon & Damico, 2011). Critique entails digging deeply into texts, examining purposes, claims, and evidence by evaluating how texts work within and across political, economic, and social

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contexts. With reflexivity, readers investigate their own backgrounds, beliefs, biases, and values and consider ways that people from different social locations (e.g., gender, race, religion, socioeconomic status, dis/ability, regional or national affiliation, military or veteran status) might engage with a text.

Stories-We-Live-By

Because texts advance different representations about social conditions in the world, Freire named the analytic process of working with texts as reading the word and reading the world (Freire & Macedo, 1987). Of particular importance is examining what Stibbe (2015) called stories-we-live-by, which are encoded in language, images, and multimedia and across other semiotic resources that permeate our physical spaces and digital landscapes (Scollon & Scollon, 2001). Whereas “stories are cognitive structures in the minds of individuals” that affect how people apprehend the world, “stories-we-live-by are stories in the minds of multiple individuals across a culture” (Stibbe, 2015, p. 6). Stibbe described how we are exposed to these mental models that influence our behavior

without consciously selecting them or necessarily being aware that they are just stories. They appear between the lines of the texts which surround us in everyday life: in news reports, advertisements, conversations with friends, the weather forecast, instruction manuals, or textbooks. They appear in educational, political, professional, medical, legal and other institutional contexts without announcing themselves as stories. (p. 5)

Literacy educators play an essential role in helping students identify and examine stories-we-live-by in their own lived experiences and in a range of texts where these stories circulate.

Two interrelated stories-we-live-by that permeate our culture and significantly shape our lives are (1) humans are the center of existence, separate from nature, and (2) consumerism, or the acquisition of goods, services, and experiences, is a primary pathway to happiness and fulfillment.

Humans Are the Center of Existence, Separate From Nature

With this story-we-live-by, humans are positioned as the most important entity on the planet, existing separate from all other species. Philosophically, this anthropocentric perspective holds that human beings possess intrinsic value, whereas other entities, such as animals, plants,

and minerals, are resources that humans can use or exploit justifiably for their benefit. This supports a view of nature as a commodity and potential source of economic value. This is a powerful story, especially in the United States, given its deep historical links to ideas of progress and economic development championed in such beliefs as manifest destiny. This story is also supported and reinforced in some religious communities, which interpret sacred texts, such as the Bible, as confirmation of (hu)man’s dominion over all other species on earth.

One instantiation of a text embodying this story is a truck or sport utility vehicle commercial in which the climate-controlled, energy-inefficient vehicle rumbles off the paved road, rambling through fields, streams, and mountainsides or across a desert landscape. In such a scene, the environment becomes a playground for humans, with little attention paid to what such activity might mean for the environment. A more subtle example, perhaps, is selfies taken by nature travelers who disrupt or damage an ecosystem in search of the perfect backdrop for their snapshots to post on social media platforms (Leetaru, 2019). In these examples, humans do not simply skim along the desert surface as they throw a car into four-wheel drive and turn off the main road, or step from a well-defined trail to snap a quick photo. Such choices, for example, can wreak havoc on the delicate crust of the desert made up of numerous organisms central to its ecosystem and health (Miller, 2017). Texts, like truck commercials and nature selfies posted online, offer possibilities to explore this anthropogenic story and consider its ramifications on specific ecosystems.

Consumerism Is a Primary Pathway to Fulfillment

A companion story-we-live-by is one that positions the acquisition of goods, services, and experiences as a primary pathway to personal happiness and fulfillment. This story of endless abundance, of purchasing and obtaining an enticing cornucopia of new, better, and more satisfying products, is perpetuated by advertising and deeply embedded in our culture. Conspicuous consumption (Veblen, 1899/1994) is a way to demonstrate one’s identity, lifestyle choices, and social status and permeates mindsets about what constitutes the good life. Consumerism creates a state of unease and chronic anxiety that can only be satisfied through more consumption (Lasch, 1984).

One illustrative example of this story can be found in President George W. Bush’s September 2001 speech to the American people, shortly after the attacks on the World Trade Center in New York City, New York,

and the Pentagon in Northern Virginia. President Bush suggested that civic responsibility, even a sense of national duty, entailed going shopping. He said, “Now, the American people have got to go about their business. We cannot let the terrorists achieve the objective of frightening our Nation to the point where we don’t—where we don’t conduct business, where people don’t shop” (Government Publishing Office, 2001, p. 1455).

Of course, the advertising industry, with the guiding principle of convincing people to purchase things that they might not have previously considered, is best known for promulgating this story-we-live-by. Consider the Delta Airlines advertising campaign “Keep climbing.” One video ad called “Runways” (<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=kKhtwKuFWQA>) uses a number of rectangular images taken from destinations around the world (e.g., a table full of food, a lakeside dock, a street), each a stand-in for a runway. As the camera zooms in on each image amid the sound of an airplane accelerating for takeoff, the narrator says:

The old saying, good things come to those who wait. It’s just that: old. Those good things? You have to get out there and chase them. We see it in the millions of people we fly around the world, all of them living proof good things come to those who go.

In this sophisticated visually and emotionally compelling ad, what is good and what it means to live fully and well is equated with the consumption of experiences through airline travel to destinations around the world. Notably, this ad, with the culminating goal of getting the viewer to leave the ground, also works figuratively to align with the “humans as separate and above nature” story. There is no shortage of other examples that embody these two stories-we-live-by: Humans are separate from the environment, and the consumption of goods, services, and experiences is a primary pathway to happiness.

So, how might literacy educators help students identify and examine these stories-we-live-by? In our work as classroom teachers and teacher educators (Baildon & Damico, 2011; Damico, Honeyford, & Panos, 2016), we advocate inquiry-based instructional approaches in which a key guiding principle is to help students pose and pursue questions about topics and texts, in this case, about these stories-we-live-by. Critical literacy principles and practices are crucial to help students better understand how texts work (Luke & Freebody, 1997), and explore questions like these: Where do these stories come from? How do they shape our understandings and experiences? What are the consequences of these stories—benefits, drawbacks, and limitations—and for which populations?

However, whereas examples of critical literacy work in classrooms continues to increase, efforts that directly target climate change remain scarce. Notable exceptions include resources from Rethinking Schools and the Zinn Education Project, such as *A People’s Curriculum for the Earth: Teaching Climate Change and the Environmental Crisis* (Bigelow & Swinehart, 2014), which includes detailed activities and lesson plans for teaching about climate change and environmental justice across content areas. Also, Beach, Share, and Webb (2017), who focus on English language arts classrooms, offered an abundant array of resources, which are also accessible through a website (<http://climatechangeela.pbworks.com/w/page/100551079/FrontPage>) and blog (English Teachers Concerned about Climate Crisis: <https://etccsite.com/blog-posts/>). These examples highlight what more focused attention to climate change can look like, and point to the potential of ecolinguistics.

Ecolinguistics and Climate Justice Literacy

Whereas linguistics, and the tools of critical language and literacy studies, offers frames to analyze the wide, diverse array of texts in our lives that shape our thoughts and actions within the communities and the larger society we belong to, the *eco* in *ecolinguistics* emphasizes ecosophy, or ecological philosophy, which is a set of value priorities and related rules and norms to guide people’s actions (Naess, 1989). Everyone makes decisions and acts in the world based on an ecosophy, whether they are consciously aware of it or not. Similarly, everyone reads, evaluates, and creates texts based on a set of values and priorities. Whereas readers making their values and priorities explicit is central to critical literacy studies, the importance of claiming one’s ecosophy, and ecological commitments more broadly, has not been. For the three of us as educators and researchers, our ecosophy acknowledges and builds from the existing scientific evidence about climate change.

The term *climate change*, used routinely in scientific research for decades (e.g., Plass, 1956), refers to changes in the global climate system that result in longer term changes, from decades to millions of years, in weather patterns. Although the global climate system is always changing, scientists have shown that this global warming trend is tied to human greenhouse gas emissions, primarily carbon dioxide and methane, and that the countries most responsible include China, the United States, the European Union, India, and Russia (Freidrich, Ge, & Pickens, 2017). As a result, the planet is in the midst of a

long-term trend in which an escalating global temperature has been leading to rising sea levels and the loss of glaciers, permafrost and sea ice, as well as to an appreciable spike in heat waves, the expansion of deserts, changes in seasonal patterns (e.g., growing seasons, bird migration, insect infestations), and greater occurrence/intensity of droughts, flooding, and fires (Environmental Protection Agency, n.d.). It also bears mentioning that all of these findings have been common knowledge in the climate science community since 1979 (Rich, 2019). Thus, we proceed here with an ecosophy that deeply values the protection and renewal of essential ecosystems that humans and all other species depend on (Stibbe, 2015). Moreover, because an ecosophy includes values and norms, it is possible to identify stories-we-live-by as destructive, beneficial, or ambivalent in terms of the ecosophy. Destructive stories do not protect essential ecosystems, beneficial stories do, and ambivalent stories are mixed (Stibbe, 2015).

So, let's return to our two stories-we-live-by to see an ecolinguistics perspective in action. The first story—humans are the center of existence, separate from nature—can more readily be read as destructive, primarily because it supports or justifies human exploitation of natural resources. Acclaimed journalist Klein (2014) traced this story back to the Scientific Revolution, early capitalism, and colonialism in the 17th century, but its roots can also be traced to humanism or human-centric views of the Renaissance period, if not back even further to ancient Greece. It is a story of progress based on the dominance of nature by humans, primarily white men with wealth and property, in which “the world [is seen] as something that exists only to gratify human desires” (Lasch, 1991, p. 527). It is a story that has been shaped by dominant systems and structures tied to gender (patriarchy), race (systemic racism and discrimination), class (economic inequality), and space or place (colonialism; Klein, 2014). As a result, any type of text that privileges human experience at the expense of adverse environmental impact, such as the aforementioned sport utility vehicle commercial, highlights how this story-we-live-by is destructive.

The second story-we-live-by—acquisition of goods, services, and experiences is the primary pathway to life fulfillment—is also destructive. It is ecologically unsustainable as greater levels of energy expenditure, with high carbon dioxide-emitting fossil fuels as the dominant energy source, are needed to match consumption levels. Using an ecolinguistics perspective, President Bush's entreaty for U.S. citizens to go shopping in response to the September 11, 2001, attacks, therefore, contributes to a destructive story. The Delta Airlines ad that promotes the acquisition of global experiences is also destructive, given the devastating carbon dioxide

atmospheric impact of airline travel. Rates and practices of consumerism (with the United States particularly in mind) have also been producing skyrocketing quantities of waste that is increasingly difficult to manage. This story is also destructive due to associated damaging impacts, namely, the links of consumerism to rising debt levels, escalating working hours, fracturing of community ties, and contributions to an epidemic of loneliness.

There are many ways to mobilize the study of such stories in the classroom. Teachers can guide students to identify specific destructive stories (e.g., the ones we identified) across a range of texts (fiction/nonfiction and print/digital) with core critical literacy questions (e.g., What story is being valued? Who benefits from this story? Who doesn't?). This might include students inquiring into destructive stories in their own lives as readers, citizens, and consumers. Where are these stories in social media? Are they in students' homes and schools? Are they in conversations among students' friends and families? What other destructive stories are evident? Exploring these stories in the classroom positions them as worthy of inquiry.

Doing this type of investigative work with texts with an ecolinguistics lens promotes climate justice literacy in classrooms. Literacy educators can also promote climate justice literacy by identifying and exploring beneficial stories-we-live-by (Stibbe, 2015).

Beneficial Stories-We-Live-By

Beneficial stories-we-live-by can restory our relationships with one another and the world (Kimmerer, 2013; Latour, 2018). Three overlapping sets of these beneficial stories emphasize indigenous narratives of place, gender and climate justice, and youth activism and civic engagement.

Indigenous Narratives of Place

Indigenous voices, perspectives, and ideas from groups such as Idle No More and Indigenous Climate Action are a generative source of stories-we-live-by, especially in places like Canada where warming (or overheating) is happening three times more quickly than the global average (see videos provided by the System Change Not Climate Change Project: <https://canadians.org/systemchange>). The website stemming from the *This Changes Everything* documentary film and book, for example, narrates a more justice-centric story-we-live-by through a lesson plan called “Reinventing a Clean and Just Economy” (<https://thischangeseverything.org/wp-content/uploads/2015/12/Lesson-Plan-5.pdf>). This story explores the experience of Henry Red Cloud, who

left his steel industry job to start his own solar power company and create jobs for those living on his North Dakota Indian reservation. In this example, students come to understand a synergy of benefits for the community, economy, and the environment as Henry aims to help First Nations people achieve energy independence. Similarly, a biologist, lyrical science writer, and member of the Potawatomi Nation, Kimmerer (2013) wrote about the braiding together of healing stories from science, literature, and indigenous knowledge to imagine and create a different relationship with the world, one based on regenerative, reciprocal relationships. Students might consider their own lives and media landscapes for more of these stories, and they might consider what such stories would mean if enacted in their own homes and schools.

Gender and Climate Justice

Another series of stories-we-live-by centers on the relation between gender and climate justice. Nagel (2016) demonstrated how gender inequalities create intersectional vulnerabilities to climate change impacts and limit access to resources after climate-related disasters and how masculinist climate research agendas shape attitudes toward climate change risks and limit political participation in processes that affect mitigation and adaptation policies. To address these inequities, especially climate change denial, which is predominantly driven by affluent white males (Nagel, 2016), teachers can delve into beneficial examples, such as the Mary Robinson Foundation—Climate Justice (<https://www.mrfcj.org/>) and the podcast series Mothers of Invention (<https://www.mothersofinvention.online/>), in which Mary Robinson, the first female president of Ireland, teams with writer/comic Maeve Higgins to highlight intergenerational climate activists whose climate justice gender work intersects with issues related to race, colonialism, social class, and poverty.

The podcast offers powerful models of women working for climate justice, such as the Black Lives Matter activist Sarra Tekola, the daughter of a climate refugee from Ethiopia, who calls for community-based solutions to climate change. She connects feminism, climate justice, and the Black Lives Matter movement to help people understand and address issues of state violence toward women of color as deeply rooted in particular colonialist legacies. She is a founding member of Women of Color Speak Out (<https://wocspeakout.com/>), a collective of Seattle activists working to educate their community about the climate crisis by connecting climate action to other social movements that help people see that it is possible to dismantle deeply rooted forms of oppression and imagine more sustainable futures. Students can

explore to what extent these perspectives are present in their lives and in their engagements with media.

Youth Activism and Civic Engagement

These are also beneficial stories-we-live-by grounded in youth-led activism and civic engagement found in projects such as Zero Hour (<http://thisiszerohour.org/>), the Sunrise movement (<https://www.sunrisemovement.org/>), Extinction Rebellion (<https://rebellion.earth/>), and School Strike for Climate Australia (<https://www.schoolstrike4climate.com/>)—all grassroots efforts to shape climate-related public policy grounded deeply in what longtime consumer advocate and public intellectual Ralph Nader (2019) called the moral power of youth. Extinction Rebellion, for example, is an international network dedicated to nonviolent direct action to convince governments to respond swiftly to our climate and ecological emergency. The Sunrise movement in the United States has also been engaged in political action, leading efforts with the Green New Deal, proposed legislation to confront climate change and economic inequality.

These overlapping and intersecting stories across indigenous perspectives, gender, race, economics, and geography offer compelling climate justice examples of community-based efforts to cultivate, nurture, and sustain relationships within and across a range of contexts. These stories confront insidious, destructive stories-we-live-by, demonstrating how it is possible to build solidarity and forge alliances “as a lived process of ongoing political and ethical action and education” (Mitchell, 2007, p. 717). Again, identifying these stories is a worthy endeavor in and of itself; yet, rather than reduce examples of these stories to a simple cataloging of good or bad, we advocate inquiry-based approaches in which students explore key features of these stories and examine how specific examples align with or challenge their own views, values, and experiences.

Being a climate justice literacy educator entails working with destructive *and* beneficial stories. In our own work with preservice and inservice teachers, we think it is important to clearly articulate core understandings about climate change that provide an essential entry point for this work, and we have found three ideas to be particularly useful.

Three Core Understandings **Climate Change Is a Complex** **Socioscientific Topic and Wicked Problem**

In the United States, there are varied perspectives about climate change (Leiserowitz et al., 2014, 2019),

associated with different political affiliations, values, or cultural worldviews (Kahan et al., 2012; Lombardi & Sinatra, 2012; McCright & Dunlap, 2011; Weber & Stern, 2011). Recent data point to a changing trend of more Americans thinking that global warming is happening and that it is human-caused (Clark, 2019), yet the findings remain mixed and shaped by the type of questions asked (Annenberg Public Policy Center, 2019). Ultimately, then, climate change is not just about science; it must be understood as a socioscientific topic that cuts across political, civic, geographic, economic, social, cultural, psychological, and historical dimensions (Damico, Panos, & Baidon, 2018; Klein, 2014), across traditions in natural science, environmentalism, activism for human justice, economics, politics, and religion (O'Brien, 2017).

Climate change is also “a global problem, felt on local scales, that will be around for decades and centuries to come” (NASA, n.d., para. 1), necessitating answers to questions about science, economics, society, politics, morality, and ethics. From a policy studies perspective, climate change can even be understood as a super wicked problem because there is not much time to address the problem, the people who caused the problem are attempting to provide solutions, the central authority needed to address the problem is weak or nonexistent, and the discounting of the problem pushes policy responses into the future (Levin, Cashore, Bernstein, & Auld, 2012). Most importantly, the framing of climate change as a sociological or socioscientific (rather than strictly a scientific) topic helps keep issues of inequality and injustice central because “sociologists are unique among scientists in [their] relentless focus on inequality” (Harlan, Pellow, & Roberts, 2015, p. 128).

Engagement With Climate Change Is Mediated Primarily by a Complicated, Diverse Array of Motivated Digital Texts and Motivated Readers

As a general rule, it is necessary to view all texts as motivated because they represent particular interests and agendas. This includes texts that have a global reach and come in the form of advertising, branding, and sponsored content that represent an “epic scramble to get inside our heads” (Wu, 2017, title), especially texts that promote denialism (rejecting what has been found to be accurate or true) or manufacture doubt and uncertainty about established scientific findings by blurring and distorting fact and opinion about climate change (Oreskes & Conway, 2010; Washington & Cook, 2011).

For example, denialist texts, such as the statement that climate change is a hoax, might try to persuade readers to reject the fact that climate change is occurring, deny that it is being caused by human activity, or dismiss the urgency of taking action. These denialist texts are most prevalent in the United States, England, and Australia, where climate science is politicized and polarized, leading some to call climate denial an Anglo-Saxon phenomenon (Painter, 2011).

As readers, we also all come to texts with particular ideas, values, perspectives, and positions of relative privilege that motivate us to receive and accept information that aligns with our beliefs or confirms preexisting perspectives as we gravitate toward echo chambers (Jamieson & Cappella, 2008; Kahne & Bowyer, 2017; Manjoo, 2008; Prior, 2013). This means that we all must understand how texts try to influence us in particular ways and how we might be swayed as readers to locate and use texts that align with our beliefs, values, and attitudes. Of central importance here is making one's ecosophy, which is often tacit, explicit.

Climate Change Is About Climate (In)justice

Today, there is greater recognition that different language is necessary to describe our present reality and to help clarify more prudent courses of action (Monbiot, 2018; Nader, 2019). Leading environmentalists, authors, and activists, including Bill McKibben and Paul Hawken, believe that terms such as *climate chaos* and *climate volatility* are more accurate. Greta Thunberg (2019), the teenager from Sweden who is a key leader in the global climate justice movement, has exhorted her followers to “stop saying ‘climate change’ and instead call it what it is: climate breakdown, climate crisis, climate emergency, ecological breakdown, ecological crisis and ecological emergency” (para. 1).

Some scholars, educators, and activists have also framed climate change more pointedly in terms of climate justice (Robinson, 2018) with an emphasis on structural inequalities and concomitant calls for comprehensive, inclusive, and systemic change (Klein, 2014; Lewis, Barnes, J., & Cuarón, 2015; Newberry & Trujillo, 2019; Smith, Tuck, & Yang, 2019; Tuck & Yang, 2018). This stems from the fact that the most devastating climate change consequences, such as limited food and water sources, will likely be felt most in some of the world's poorest countries, where injustices compound over time when communities lose assets and income, especially when extreme weather events continue to occur (Islam & Winkel, 2017). The injustices intensify further because

the countries and communities that use significantly less fossil fuel-based energy are least responsible for climate change, as unsustainable consumerism and carbon-reliant economies in more affluent countries continue to drive our current climate crisis (Harlan et al., 2015).

The Journey Ahead

Although these three core understandings, and the preceding consideration of destructive and beneficial stories-we-live-by, are grounded in climate change science and research on inequitable impacts of climate change, one's ecosophy can lead to different interpretations of these stories. The community in which one resides also has an impact on the ways that stories-we-live-by are dealt with in the classroom. Because climate change remains a deeply divisive and politically partisan issue in the United States, teachers who work in communities where climate change denial is more prevalent are likely at greater risk of being sanctioned negatively by peers, administrators, or community members. Yet, this does not mean that teaching through climate change justice literacy is not possible.

In our recent work with future teachers with varied beliefs about climate change (from alarmed to dismissive), we found that guiding them through an inquiry process in which they evaluate competing online sources about climate change and deliberate their evaluations with peers can help them investigate and challenge their own beliefs and work toward more scientifically based understandings of climate change (Damico & Panos, 2016, 2018). Another approach to address political polarization is to bring local issues and related stories into the classroom. The need to respond to a timely and consequential problem in the community, such as groundwater contamination or dealing with a superstorm like Hurricanes Sandy, Irma, Maria, Dorian, and Harvey or wildfires like the deadly 2018 camp fire in northern California, can redirect or minimize more rigid political differences as people come together across these differences to address problems at hand.

A recent example from our work with current literacy teachers highlights what this can look like. A middle school language arts teacher, who works at a politically conservative religious school in Florida, designed a climate justice inquiry for her students to examine the water health of the state's largest inland body of water, Lake Okeechobee, which is currently suffering from industrial pollution and toxic algae. Her inquiry took the form of critically evaluating the types of news stories being written about the issue, field trips to local parks and the lake, student-created photo-essays about the local

environment and its health, and making connections with local environmental and climate-focused activist groups. The project culminated in a whole-class podcast shared with their schoolmates. Although the teacher expressed concern about the political nature of climate change as a broad topic, she found that positioning the inquiry project with her students through a local environmental issue shifted the story to children's lives and opportunities, rather than entrenched political debates.

Literacy educators are uniquely positioned to help students identify and examine ecologically destructive and beneficial stories-we-live-by that circulate in an escalating array of complicated, motivated texts about climate change. Literacy educators can begin this work by enriching their own understandings of the climate crisis and making climate justice more central in their classrooms. This includes exploring relations among nature, community, and place within their own communities and beyond to help develop and articulate their own ecosophies, which

TAKE ACTION!

1. Learn more about climate justice education. Consult websites such as the Alliance for Climate Education (<https://acespace.org/>), Climate Visuals (<https://climatevisuals.org/>), and English Teachers Concerned about Climate Crisis (<https://etcccsite.com/>).
2. Develop or sharpen critical language skills by taking a free ecolinguistics course online called *The Stories We Live By*, which is led by Arran Stibbe, a professor of ecological Linguistics at the University of Gloucestershire (<http://storiesweliveby.org.uk/>).
3. Develop and define your own ecosophy. Use the subsection "The Ecosophy of This Book" in Stibbe's (2015) Introduction section as an example.
4. Identify at least one destructive story-we-live-by and locate texts that represent it. You can draw from this article for examples or from the course website in #2 above.
5. Identify at least one beneficial story-to-live-by and locate texts that represent it.
6. Teach examples to your students and reflect on what happens in the class conversations.
7. Seek colleagues within and across your content area to collaborate on the design and implementation of climate justice learning activities for students.
8. Connect with colleagues, parents, and other community members to advocate for climate justice education (e.g., curriculum, professional development) at your school and on the district and statewide levels.

in turn can spark students' explorations of their ecosophies and how to more intentionally engage with the word and the world in ways that align with their ecosophies. Teachers finding ways to collaborate with colleagues across subject matter areas to understand and address climate justice as fundamentally inter- or transdisciplinary is also key (Beach et al., 2017; Damico & Baildon, 2011). There is no shortage of important work to do.

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MORE TO EXPLORE

- Listen to indigenous rapper and climate change activist Xiuhtezcatl Martinez's music in the video "Music ft. Tru" (<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=E4kGHvWFHYk&feature=youtu.be>) and his TEDxYouth talk (<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=o2V2yVkedtM>).
- Follow Greta Thunberg's Twitter feed (https://twitter.com/GretaThunberg?ref_src=twsrc%5Egoogle%7Ctwcamp%5Eserp%7Ctwgr%5Eauthor) and listen to her TEDxStockholm talk (https://www.ted.com/talks/greta_thunberg_the_disarming_case_to_act_right_now_on_climate_change?language=en).
- Explore the Climate Justice Resource Kit provided by Rethinking Schools: <https://www.rethinkingschools.org/climate-justice-resource-kit>.
- Delve into the Cloud Institute for Sustainability Education, which focuses on preparing school systems and communities to educate for sustainable futures: <https://cloudinstitute.org/>.